

LIVE DATA SNAPSHOT - PULLED 26 FEBRUARY 2026 | 08:02 EST

| INDICATOR                     | LATEST VALUE   | PERIOD     | CHANGE                   | SOURCE          |
|-------------------------------|----------------|------------|--------------------------|-----------------|
| Brent Crude                   | 71.90 USD/bbl  | 2026-02-23 | -\$0.85 vs 2026-02-20    | local-db (fred) |
| WTI Crude                     | 66.36 USD/bbl  | 2026-02-23 | -\$0.33 vs 2026-02-20    | local-db (fred) |
| Heating Oil NY                | 2.60 USD/gal   | 2026-02-23 | +\$0.11 vs 2026-02-20    | local-db (fred) |
| Henry Hub Nat Gas (Monthly)   | 7.72 USD/MMBtu | Jan 2026   | +\$3.46 vs Dec 2025      | local-db (fred) |
| US Regular Gasoline           | 2.94 USD/gal   | 2026-02-23 | +\$0.01 vs 2026-02-16    | local-db (fred) |
| US Diesel (Retail)            | 3.81 USD/gal   | 2026-02-23 | +\$0.10 vs 2026-02-16    | local-db (fred) |
| US Crude Imports              | 6,524 MBPD     | 2026-02-13 | -281 MBPD vs 2026-02-06  | local-db (eia)  |
| US Crude Exports              | 4,590 MBPD     | 2026-02-13 | +851 MBPD vs 2026-02-06  | local-db (eia)  |
| US Crude Stocks               | 419.8 MMbbl    | 2026-02-13 | -9.0 MMbbl vs 2026-02-06 | local-db (eia)  |
| US Crude Production           | 13,735 MBPD    | 2026-02-13 | +22 MBPD vs 2026-02-06   | local-db (eia)  |
| US Gasoline Stocks            | 255.8 MMbbl    | 2026-02-13 | -3.2 MMbbl vs 2026-02-06 | local-db (eia)  |
| US Distillate Stocks          | 120.1 MMbbl    | 2026-02-13 | -4.6 MMbbl vs 2026-02-06 | local-db (eia)  |
| US Nat Gas Storage (Lower 48) | 2,070 Bcf      | 2026-02-13 | -144 Bcf vs 2026-02-06   | local-db (eia)  |

Green = fresh local data · Amber = stale - verify before use · Purple = synthetic test data · Stale thresholds: daily FRED 7d · weekly FRED 10d · EIA weekly 14d · monthly series 35d

0 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Maritime flows through the Strait of Hormuz remain stable, with ~20–21 MBPD crude and condensate transits, representing ~20% of globally traded petroleum. Henry Hub has surged by \$3.46 to \$7.72/MMBtu, marking the most notable data move. Brent is currently priced at \$71.90/bbl, with a widening Brent-WTI spread at \$5.54/bbl due to elevated geopolitical risk. US natural gas storage has decreased to 2,070 Bcf, signaling tightening supply conditions. Risk bias: Stable operational posture; asymmetric upside disruption risk.

**1 STRATEGIC OVERVIEW**

The Strait of Hormuz is a critical chokepoint for global oil supply, facilitating ~20–21 MBPD crude and condensate transits, which accounts for ~20% of globally traded petroleum. Key Gulf producers, including Saudi Arabia, Iraq, UAE, Kuwait, and Iran, heavily depend on these maritime routes for their export revenues. Current US production stands at 13,735 MBPD, with exports at 4,590 MBPD, reflecting a robust engagement in global markets. Regional geopolitical volatility preserves asymmetric disruption risk.

**2 OPERATIONAL ENVIRONMENT**

The operational environment remains stable, supported by the presence of the US 5th Fleet and Coalition Maritime Forces (CMF). However, IRGCN presence sustains latent escalation potential, underscoring the need for vigilance in maritime security. The current force posture is adequate to deter immediate threats but remains susceptible to sudden geopolitical shifts.

**3 COMMERCIAL SHIPPING & ENERGY MARKET INDICATORS**

The most significant absolute move is in Henry Hub, which has risen to \$7.72/MMBtu, driven by seasonal demand factors unrelated to Gulf maritime flows. Brent is currently priced at \$71.90/bbl, reflecting a slight decline of \$0.85 since February 20, 2026, while the Brent-WTI spread has widened to \$5.54/bbl, indicating a geopolitical risk premium in the market. WTI stands at \$66.36/bbl, maintaining a consistent relationship with Brent amid ongoing market dynamics.

**4 72-HOUR WATCHPOINTS**

Key watchpoints include Brent breaking above approximately \$75.00/bbl, which would signal heightened market tension. Additionally, Henry Hub exceeding \$8.00/MMBtu could indicate significant shifts in natural gas supply and demand dynamics. Finally, any escalation in military activity involving the IRGCN in the Strait of Hormuz would necessitate immediate reassessment of risk exposure.

© 2026 Randy Hinton. All rights reserved. Unauthorized reproduction, distribution, or transmission of this brief, in whole or in part, is strictly prohibited without prior written consent. Market data sourced from local storeroom (EIA/FRED observations). Distribution: Gues